

INTERNATIONAL news

Intel begins advanced EUV manufacturing in Ireland plant

Intel is embarking on advanced manufacturing in Europe, using extreme ultraviolet (EUV) lithography machines at its plant in Leixlip, Ireland. The Leixlip-based plant will be responsible for producing Intel's upcoming 'Meteor Lake' chip, designed



for laptops and AI-powered personal computers. The Leixlip plant has seven large EUV machines and a complex system of overhead robots for silicon wafer handling. These EUV machines are manufactured by Advanced Semiconductor Materials Lithography (ASML) and are integral to Intel's manufacturing processes. Intel is expanding its European footprint with plans for a substantial chip complex in Germany and an assembly and test facility in Poland, taking advantage of the EU's funding regulations and subsidies.

US grants Samsung, SK Hynix indefinite waiver to supply chips using US tech to Chinese factories

The US government has granted Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix an indefinite exemption to import advanced American machinery, allowing them to supply chips with US technology to Chinese factories without separate approval. This move resolves a significant trade issue for Korean semiconductor companies. The South Korean semiconductor companies are major suppliers and consumers of equipment, accounting for 60.5% of the

world's memory output, and this decision stabilises the global semiconductor supply chain.

EU to attract \$43.7 B in private investment with Chips Act

The European Union (EU) has enacted the Chips Act to bolster its semiconductor market, aiming to double its global market share to 20% by 2030. This act involves significant investments and creating an alert system to address semiconductor supply chain disruptions. The EU plans to attract \$43.7 billion in private investment, with \$3.6 billion of its funds supporting the act. The legislation came into effect five months after the agreement between the European Council and the European Parliament on the final draft of the act.

Amazon to invest \$4B in AI startup Anthropic

Amazon plans to invest around \$4 billion in the AI startup Anthropic, securing a significant partnership to bolster its position in generative artificial intelligence. As part of the agreement, Anthropic will leverage Amazon Web Services (AWS) data centres and Amazon's in-house chips for model training, particularly for chatbots and other AI tools. Amazon will hold a minority stake in Anthropic, following the investment. The collaboration between Amazon and Anthropic is expected to benefit both companies, with Amazon's engineers gaining access to Anthropic's models. This partnership is also significant for Amazon's internal chip production, as Anthropic will use AWS chips for its foundational AI models.

Infineon acquires UWB technology innovator 3db Access

Infineon Technologies AG has acquired 3db Access AG, a Zurich-based UWB (ultra wide-band) technology innovator, to strengthen its presence in the Internet of Things (IoT) sector. This acquisition will enable Infineon to offer enhanced secure smart access, precise localisation, and advanced sensing capabilities. The integration of UWB technology will enable secure access, indoor navigation, precise location tracking, and presence detection using UWB radars. The CEO of 3db Access, Boris Danev, emphasised the importance of UWB technology in smartphones, cars, and IoT devices.

Algeria's 2,000MW solar power project receives 73 bids

Algeria has attracted 73 bids for its ambitious solar power project, aiming to generate 2,000MW renewable energy, with a

BII to invest \$1B in Indian renewable energy sector

British International Investment (BII), a UK government development finance institution, plans to invest around \$1 billion in Indian climate-related projects by 2026, primarily focusing on renewable energy and other environmentally sustainable sectors. BII's CEO, Nick O'Donohoe, mentioned that they are exploring investments in sectors such as biofuels and the circular economy, aligning with the

2030 roadmap agreed upon by India and the UK. BII's current portfolio in India is valued at \$2.2 billion, spanning over 290 businesses. They had also committed to investing up to \$250 million in Mahindra and Mahindra Ltd's electric vehicle unit.

India explores potential chip partnership with Israel-based Tower Semiconductor

Minister of State Rajeev Chandrasekhar met with Israel-based Tower Semiconductor CEO and

Israel's Ambassador to India, Naor Gilon, to discuss a potential partnership in the semiconductor industry. Tower Semiconductor was part of the International Semiconductor Consortium (ISMC), which applied for India's semiconductor incentive scheme. Previously, the acquisition of Tower Semiconductor by Intel had put the ISMC's application on hold, but with the Intel deal off, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology reengaged with Tower Semiconductor. The meeting with the Tower